The result should be something like this:

```
SELECT people.id, people.name, comments.text
FROM people
INNER JOIN comments
  ON comments.person_id = people.id
WHERE comments.created_at = '2015-01-01'
```

16.2 Retrieving specific data from multiple tables

```
Person
  .select('people.id, people.name, companies.name')
  .joins(:company)
  .find_by('people.name' => 'John') # this should be the last
```

The above should generate:

```
SELECT people.id, people.name, companies.name
FROM people
INNER JOIN companies
  ON companies.person_id = people.id
WHERE people.name = 'John'
LIMIT 1
```

Note that if a query matches multiple records, `find_by` will fetch only the first one and ignore the others (see the `LIMIT 1` statement above).

17 Find or Build a New Object

It's common that you need to find a record or create it if it doesn't exist. You can do that with the `find_or_create_by` and `find_or_create_by!` methods.

17.1 `find_or_create_by`

The `find_or_create_by` method checks whether a record with the attributes exists. If it doesn't, then`create` is called. Let's see an example.

Suppose you want to find a client named 'Andy', and if there's none, create one. You can do so by running:

```
Client.find_or_create_by(first_name: 'Andy')
# => #<Client id: 1, first_name: "Andy", orders_count: 0, locked:
true, created_at: "2011-08-30 06:09:27", updated_at: "2011-08-30
06:09:27">
```

The SQL generated by this method looks like this:

```
SELECT * FROM clients WHERE (clients.first_name = 'Andy') LIMIT 1
BEGIN
INSERT INTO clients (created_at, first_name, locked, orders_count,
updated_at) VALUES ('2011-08-30 05:22:57', 'Andy', 1, NULL, '2011-08-30
05:22:57')
COMMIT
```

`find_or_create_by` returns either the record that already exists or the new record. In our case, we didn't already have a client named Andy so the record is created and returned.

The new record might not be saved to the database; that depends on whether validations passed or not (just like `create`).

Suppose we want to set the 'locked' attribute to `false` if we're creating a new record, but we don't want to include it in the query. So we want to find the client named "Andy", or if that client doesn't exist, create a client named "Andy" which is not locked.

We can achieve this in two ways. The first is to use `create_with`: